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Prayer and Revival

If prayer is anything at all, it is everything; and if we accept the fact that it means everything, we must also acknowledge that prayer is greatly neglected in our Christian life. Do we in truth know what prayer is, and what it means? The disciples requested of Jesus, "Lord, teach us to pray." Do we not also need to learn the secret and master the art of prevailing prayer? We may learn the definition of prayer, and even learn to say prayers; but to learn to pray as Jesus did and as many of His efficient followers have done, is what we most need to know.

Dr. R. T. Horton says: "There are twelve parts to prayer: meditation, aspiration, adoration, recollection, thanksgiving, praise, contrition, confession, faith, supplication, petition, and intercession." Many Christians deal in several of these elements of prayer, but fail to enter into that experience of a full rounded prayer life that brings Heaven to earth and vital results into the experience and service. Spurgeon says: "Prayer pulls the rope below and the great bell rings above in the ears of God. Some scarcely stir the bell, for they pray so languidly; others give but an occasional pluck at the rope; but he who wins with Heaven is the man who grasps the rope boldly and pulls continuously with all his might." Ah, is not the reason of our weakness discerned? Do not our prayers lack in those strong elements of faith and intercession, or else being so languid do we only feebly pull the rope of prayer?

Consecration

ONLY today is mine,
And that I owe to Thee.
Help me to make it Thine,
As pure as it may be;
Let it see something done;
Let it see something won;
Then at the setting sun,
I'll give it back to Thee.

What if I cannot tell
The cares the day may bring?
I know that I shall dwell
Beneath Thy sheltering wing;
And there the load is light,
And there the dark is bright,
And weakness turns to might,
And so I trust and sing.

What shall I ask today?
Naught but Thine own sweet will.
The windings of the way
Lead to Thy holy hill;
And whether here or there,
Why should I fear or care?
Thy heavens are everywhere,
And they are o'er me still.

Give me Thyself today;
I dare not walk alone.
Speak to me by the way,
And "all things" are my own,—
The treasures of Thy grace,
The secret hiding place,
The vision of Thy face,
The shadow of Thy throne!

—*Henry Burton.*

Jacob, wrestling in prayer, is set forth as a type of God's people in the last days pleading earnestly in their intercessions.

"Jacob's experience during that night of wrestling and anguish represents the trial through which the people of God must pass just before Christ's second coming. The prophet Jeremiah, in holy vision looking down to this time, said: 'We have heard a voice of trembling, of fear, and not of peace. . . . All faces are turned into paleness. Alas! for that day is great, so that none is like it: it is even the time of Jacob's trouble; but he shall be saved out of it.' Jer. 30: 5-7"—"*Patriarchs and Prophets,*" *page 201.*

"When men are as devoted as Elijah was and possess the faith that he had, God will reveal Himself as He did then. When men plead with the Lord as did Jacob, the results that were seen then will again be seen. Power will come from God in answer to the prayer of faith."—"*Gospel Workers,*" *page 255.*

Intercession, this crowning element of prayer, Jacob learned at last. He had communed with God somewhat before, but now he really entered into the audience chamber with his God. Intercession, the dynamic of soul efficiency,—this is what we so much need to learn, and experience.

"Of all the calls flung out across the world the sovereign summons is to intercession. No other call carries with it the promise of fellowship with Christ so intimate, the probability of conflict so severe, the certainty of power to carry burdens and bear pains so large, the inspiration of possibilities of achievement so compelling. Upon no other human factor in world redemption do so many and so weighty issues depend."

We have already referred to Jacob—a type of those who pass through the trying and tragic scenes and great trials in the closing of God's

work on earth. These experiences, and learning the art of prevailing prayer, alone can fit us to dwell with God even as these same experiences prepared Jacob after his exile and wanderings to dwell in Canaan and be the father of the children of promise.

Dr. Cuyler some years ago said: "Most revivals have humble beginnings, and the fire starts in a few warm hearts. Never despise the day of small things. During all my own long ministry, nearly every work of grace had a similar beginning. One commenced in a meeting gathered at a few hours' notice in a private house. Another commenced in a group gathered for Bible study by Mr. Moody in our mission chapel. Still another—the most powerful of all—was kindled on a bitter January evening at a meeting of young Christians under my roof. Dr. Spencer, in his "Pastors' Sketches," tells us that a remarkable revival in his church sprang from the fervent prayers of a godly old man who was confined to his room by lameness. That profound Christian, Dr. Thomas H. Skinner, of the Union Theological Seminary, once gave me an account of a remarkable coming together of three earnest men in his study when he was pastor of the Arch Street Church in Philadelphia. They literally wrestled in prayer. They made a clean breast in confession of sin, and humbled themselves before God. One and another church officer came in and joined them. The heaven-kindled flame soon spread through the whole congregation in one of the most powerful revivals ever known in that city."

Prayer of this nature will bring to the Seventh-day Adventist Church a great revival. This is what we most need. The time demands it. "It is time for Thee, Lord, to work."

"A revival of true godliness among us is the greatest and most urgent of all our needs. To seek this should be our first work. There must be earnest effort to obtain the blessing of the Lord, not because God is not willing to bestow His blessing upon us, but because we are unprepared to receive it. Our Heavenly Father is more willing to give His Holy Spirit to them that ask Him, than are earthly parents to give good gifts to their children. But it is our work by confession, humiliation, repentance, and earnest prayer, to fulfil the conditions upon which God has promised to grant us His blessing. A revival need be expected only in answer to prayer."—*Review and Herald, March 22, 1887.*

"Revive Thy work, O Lord, Thy mighty arm make bare;
Speak with the voice that wakes the dead, and make Thy people hear.

"Revive Thy work, O Lord, disturb this sleep of death;
Quicken the smould'ring embers now by Thine almighty breath.

"Revive Thy work, O Lord, create soul-thirst for Thee;
And hung'ring for the bread of life, oh, may our spirits be.

"Revive Thy work, O Lord, exalt Thy precious name;
And by the Holy Ghost our love for Thee and Thine inflame."

We cannot plead that we do not need a revival. Our own hearts teach us differently. Abounding iniquity has led many into coldness and worldliness.

"Today a large part of those who compose our congregations are dead in trespasses and sins. They come and go like the door upon its hinges. For years they have complacently listened to the most solemn, soul-stirring truths, but they have not put them into practice. Therefore they are less and less sensible of the preciousness of truth. The stirring testimonies of reproof and warning do not arouse them to repentance. The sweetest melodies that come from God through human lips,—justification by faith, and the righteousness of Christ,—do not call forth from them a response of love and gratitude. Though the heavenly Merchantman displays before them the richest jewels of faith and love, though He invites them to buy of Him 'gold tried in the fire,' and 'white raiment' that they may be clothed, and 'eyesalve' that they may see, they steel their hearts against Him, and fail to exchange their lukewarmness for love and zeal. While making a profession, they deny the power of godliness. If they continue in this state, God will reject them. They are unfitting themselves to be members of His family."—*Vol. VI, pages 426, 427.*

The Laodicean message, Thou art lukewarm, applies to us to-day. We need a revival. Shall we not pray for it? Are we not concerned about our spiritual state? God will be gracious when we are in earnest.

"There is nothing that Satan fears so much as that the people of God shall clear the way by removing every hindrance, so that the Lord can pour out His Spirit upon a languishing church and an impenitent congregation. If Satan has his way, there would never be another awakening, great or small, to the end of time. But we are not ignorant of his devices. It is possible to resist his power. When the way is prepared for the Spirit of God, the blessing will come. Satan can no more hinder a shower of blessing from descending upon God's people than he can close the windows of heaven that rain cannot come upon the earth. Wicked men and devils cannot hinder the work of God or shut out His presence from the assemblies of His people if they will with subdued, contrite hearts confess and put away their sins, and in faith claim His promises."—*General Conference Bulletin.*

The first great revival of the church in apostolic days had its origin in a week of prayer. Of the disciples it is recorded, "These all with one accord continued stedfastly in prayer." Acts 1:14 (R.V.). That revival proved genuine and permanent, for they "continued stedfastly" in the doctrine and in prayer, and thousands were converted and added to the church. Every true revival must have its origin in heart searchings and prayer. This is our greatest need, the Lord tells us. The devil knows it also, and is trying hard to hinder the revival spirit by carelessness, worldliness, lack of devotion, and many other things, notably prayerless lives and neglect of Bible and "Testimonies." The great cry of our day is more work, place the wheels of organisation into motion, multiply methods of activity, reach goals, finish the work; but while these things are right in their place, the great need of the church is prayer. Truly we need a revival of true godliness, and as a revival has its human beginning in prayer, let us pray that God may be merciful to His people.

"Father of mercies! these the long-astray,
These in soul blindness now the far-away,
These are not aliens, but Thy sons before,
O, by Thy Fatherhood, restore, restore!

"Breathe on Thy Church, that it may greet the day,
Stir up her will to turn, repent, and pray,
Till Zionward again salvation come,
And all her outcast children are at home."

J. E. FULTON.

The Weekly Visitor

HOW can an isolated member witness for the Lord in this last message to a dying world?

There are perhaps many ways, but no doubt the most effectual way is when one entertains a weekly visitor to the knowledge of the neighbours of other denominations who are living around and watching every movement of that strange man living alone in a tent. He is known to go out every Sunday morning to his work, it may be wood-cutting or post-cutting or fence-erecting or post-boring or wiring, for preference one of the last three so that no sound of the axe will be heard to disturb the peace of any neighbours who may believe that Sunday is really the Sabbath and desire to keep it as such.

And every day during the week he continues his work until Friday afternoon. But why is it that he appears so different and speaks so differently from people in general, causing remarks to be made as to his character and bearing towards others? They do not know that every morning as he rises he kneels at his bedside to thank the Lord for His protecting care during the night and for the health and strength with which he has risen this morning, and asks for a touch of the Saviour to give victory over the weakness of the flesh in all things during the day before him. And they do not know, per-

haps, that as his breakfast is preparing he takes the morning lesson and studies the portion set for the day, and again approaches our Father in Heaven in prayer for strength, for love, "deep love to God and man;" that he asks a blessing on every meal as the time comes around for him to partake of it; and as each day closes, before retiring to rest, a few more words with the Master, and a prayer for peaceful rest to all God's people and for all the honest-hearted in all denominations who are looking for light.

But why does he come home so early on Friday afternoon? It is to prepare things for the morrow (Saturday, the Sabbath), and his weekly visitor. Therefore when he has come into camp, those living nearby can see the fire burning brightly, the lone man busy dusting the bag carpets out of his tent, sweeping around, and then cooking victuals that are to be eaten cold the next day. So the afternoon goes on, and while the food is cooking there comes the last shave of the week, the hot bath of the week, and the cleaning of boots. Towards sundown everything is prepared for the evening meal and the meals of the morrow. Of course he has changed his clothes, for he is expecting after tea the weekly visitor whom he entertains regularly every week-end at his camp, and he would not have his visitor find anything out of order.

Tea over, he turns to "Christ in Song," and selects one or two simple hymns that can be sung alone, and then possibly may turn to No. 385, "Sabbath Dawn." Closing the hymns, he will take the Book of books, God's holy Word, and turn to some chosen verse for evening worship. Perhaps he will read Ps. 50:5, then Ps. 51:17, then Rom. 12:1; Ps. 107:22; Heb. 13:5, and then Phil. 4:15, and so he reads of the self-supporting missionary work of Paul. He thinks how a great work may be done around him by one with the same power and inspiration as Paul had, little knowing what the life he is living is doing in the hearts of his neighbours.

And now the Book is closed, and falling upon his knees on this preparation evening as the sun is setting in the west, he welcomes his weekly visitor, the Sabbath day, with thankfulness to God for setting this day aside that he, even he, in this isolated position can commune with the Father through the Holy Spirit for one whole day in the seven. As he kneels in praise these words come again to mind, "The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit: a broken and contrite heart, O God, Thou wilt not despise." Ps. 51:17. And then the glorious call, "Gather My saints together, unto Me; those that have made a covenant with Me by sacrifice." Ps. 50:5.

A SUBSCRIBER.

Our Mission Field

Jottings from a Personal Letter

THE new church building here at Dovele I had hoped to have completed by May, but we are very short-handed, as so many of our young men have left us. Seven of them went as students to the new training school when it opened; four are now missionaries; three are teachers; two went on the *Melanesia* as part of the crew; one is with a doctor as nurse, and then the Sega natives returned to their home after being here three and a half years. I do not mind losing them, because they are all doing some good work. I am pleased to have such a good spirit among those who are left.

Mrs. Tutty and I have just spent one week on the Duki coast. We took our organ, and the people did appreciate it. The work is advancing there. The five new Sabbath schools are doing well, and in two places the natives have started day school also. I am planning to go there again in a fortnight's time for another week, and then I hope to bring together in one place those who are to go forward in baptism.

We had good weather for our Duki trip, but the very day we arrived home the weather broke up for the second spell of north-westerlies.

All dogs and guns here are to be taxed, —dogs 5s. and guns 10s. I am glad this is so. I have been bitten twice since I have been out here. I am afraid that the wild pig question will be a big one to deal with soon.

Two Duki girls are here to learn sewing. Eleven are preparing for baptism at Dovele, and over twenty at Modo.

R. H. TUTTY.

Social Life of Our Missionaries' Wives in Fiji

DO we wives of the mission field ever pay calls? Why yes, of course we do. Why not? One of the greatest pleasures we have is to receive or pay a call. If we should wish to visit Sister McLaren now it would take over twelve hours, most likely over a very boisterous sea; or Sister Stewart, ten hours over the sea; while Sister Carr and Sister Branster live over two days' journey away up the Wainibuka River. So though we are not just within coo-ee of each other and our calls are therefore very rare, we do enjoy such treats.

It being vacation time at Buresala we decided to visit the Wainibuka. To reach this river means a day's journey over the sea from our island. It was Christmas Day when we left, and although we were under a tropical sun and becoming exceedingly browned, we enjoyed a perfect trip.

The sea ofttimes is not so kind. I think one never feels quite so helpless as when on a small launch, with little children, the engine not too dependable, and heavy seas dashing their fury over the hull. It is at such times we more fully realise the protecting care of our Heavenly Father.

Upon entering the river, night found us ready to rest at a native village. The best was offered us. It is on such occasions as these one appreciates the hospitable trait in the native character.

Next morning we were glad to learn that Brethren Carr and Branster were not far ahead with the *Rarama*, helping the natives up with timber for the mission building. By noon we were with them and here the Buresala launch, *Dina*, was able to help out considerably by towing the timber up as far as the mission school at Navuso.

The river is indeed very beautiful. Everything seemed so calm and restful after the sea. But what are these floating down in the distance? I have never seen such crude—shall I say boats! Here they are—bamboo trunks, perhaps fifty of them, all tied securely together forming a raft. Overhead in a half-circle a thatchwork of banana leaves is woven, forming a cool and complete shelter from the sun. The men folk have large poles steering, while the women and children are under the thatchwork. Now we can distinguish saucepans, provisions, and all household requisites. One of them has just landed in a whirl-current and if we do not help them out, we are told, they may just go round and round for an hour or so. But who are these people and where are they going? Why, they are our boys and their families setting off again for Buresala! They will travel this fashion for several days to the mouth of the river and then by launch across the sea.

At first it appeared amusing to see our students going to school in this fashion, especially when we contrast the travelling of students at home, and yet it was almost touching. These boys had with them on those little crafts, every earthly possession —wives and babies included. Behind in their towns they were leaving all the pleasures and associations that mean so much to a native. What is the motive? At school there is of necessity only the hum-drum routine which binds them so. There is no other motive but that of service for God. Oh, may we as workers keep this motive ever before them, clear and radiant, till its fulfilment!

Navuso is indeed prettily situated, and preparations for the new year were well under way. Sister Carr happened to be with Sister Branster, and they were well into the mysteries of tomato jam when we arrived. This same tomato jam proved to be delicious. We spent a real enjoyable time together. Arthur and Ivy Carr, little Russell Branster and the little Palmer boys had such a rare romp that their mammas had a time to place the little ones in slumber-land that night. It is strange too how these little ones pick up Fijian. One little boy I heard of recently said to his mother when she was relating the story of the flood, "Mamma, tell me in Fijian, I can understand it better."

The return journey was eventful. It was planned that we spend the night at a small European town at the mouth of the river, but just at dusk the engine stopped. The flies at this time of the year are in swarms, and just as they went to bed, out came mosquitoes uncountable. Night fell. The little boys were put to sleep, one on each bench. I fixed myself not to tumble over the engine. At 10 p.m., exhausted with trying to start the engine, Mr. Palmer went to rest on the floor. Rest—did I say? The mosquitoes did not rest. The boys above were to pole

us down with the current, but one by one, wearied, they fell asleep. In the early morning we were awakened by a knocking sound. We had run into sugar barges just as we reached our destination. The current had carried us down. Strange, too, we had kept in the right course, though all on board were sleeping.

Do we ever have shadows and disappointments in our mission work? Yes, ah many! But may be it is they lie too deeply down in our hearts. We do not tell them. We pray that the Master will have us learn entirely and submissively the lesson He has for us in these experiences, and then that we may rise with renewed power to finish the work.

DORA PALMER.

Education Department

Did You?

ON the blackboard in the College chapel, the Art teacher has placed a representation in colour of the well-known picture, Christ in Gethsemane. The attitude of prayer is in itself suggestive, and in addition each day one verse of the following poem (from the *Youth's Instructor* of March 4) makes its silent appeal to nearly two hundred hearts:—

Did you have a talk with Jesus
Ere you started work today?
Did you ask Him just to lead you,
That you might not go astray?
Did you tell Him all your weakness?
Of each burden you must bear?
Did you ask Him just to help you
With your heavy load of care?

Did you thank Him for the lessons
You have learned at His dear feet?
For the fulness of salvation
In His sacrifice complete?
Did you tell Him of the blessings
He bestows on you each day?
Of His love and tender mercy
Even when your footsteps stray?

Did you pledge to Him the service
Of a consecrated heart?
Tell Him you are ever ready
In His work to have a part?
Did you ask Him just to fill you
With the Spirit's mighty power
As you labour in His vineyard
Day by day, and hour by hour?

Did you wait to hear His answer
As you knelt with Him in prayer?
Did you feel the sacred presence
Of His Holy Spirit there?
His great heart is touched with pity,
And He longs to have you feel
That His angels hover near you
As before the throne you kneel.

Every soul who seeks, believing,
Will find perfect rest and peace,
Joy, which passeth understanding,
And a love that will increase.
When the final day of glory
Finds you on the other shore,
You will greet this blessed Saviour
Whom you ever will adore.

The Church at Work

THE Avondale church presented a very busy scene on the evening of March 15. There we found the parents, the young men, and the young women, and even the grandmother of over eighty summers, all with eager, expectant faces. Why have they gathered? Eager voices answer, "Tomorrow our Appeal for Missions campaign commences, and we are here to receive our marching orders."

The spirit of service pervaded the gathering. It did not take long to allot each person his territory, and to hand to him his papers and collecting cards. After this, all settled down to listen to Brother Roy W. Lane, while he told of the missionary work being carried forward in Fiji. His talk was illustrated by a very fine set of lantern slides.

Next day, earliest dawn found many on the way to their various fields of labour, and the days were spent in talking with the people about our work, and inviting them to help with their means to carry on this great missionary enterprise. Many and varied were the responses, reaching all the way from the humble threepenny piece to the five guinea cheque.

Each day, as the shades of evening gathered, we found the workers wending their way homeward, tired in body, but very light in heart. They had had the blessed privilege of working another day for the Lord, and had indeed found Him a good Master.

On the Sabbath all were glad to find that £90 had been gathered in, and that well over half of our allotted aim of £150 had been reached. From then the mercury rose steadily, and by the second Sabbath of the campaign it had reached the £123 level.

During the third week the weather became very wet and cold, but this fact did not effect our thermometer. Up, up, it went—£145, £146, and then came £8 to be reported. Bang! smash! away went the glass, and upward flew the mercury. Our aim was reached. But reaching that level only showed higher heights to be reached. We are glad that we have still territory to work, and that there are souls ready to listen to the gospel story and to help send it to others who still await its coming.

We regret that many of our brethren have not been able to join in the campaign owing to pressure of work in the Industries, but they have done what they could, and will therefore reap their reward. As a church we are all interested in and pray for the £ s. d. (Lost Souls Discovered) movement, and ask the Lord to tend carefully the good seed sown in His name, and bring it to full fruition.

EVA A. ESCREET.

College Notes

SINCE last reporting fourteen new students have joined our ranks, to whom we extend a hearty welcome. Tasmania is well represented among them, and South Australia has not forgotten to add its quota.

ON March 31 we were pleased to greet Pastor A. H. White, who took the chapel hour to report on the Ingathering work in North New South Wales. His figures were most encouraging, and all were interested because of having had a part.

OUR next is a musical note, a full chord, rather, struck by the Music Department. This department keeps Brother Martin very busy, and it has been found necessary to give him some assistance in the pianoforte section. This help is supplied by Brother Len Minchin, recently of Darling Range School, who is finishing a course with us this year.

THE College Band has been organised with a membership of twenty-six, and the Orchestra with twenty. We are well supplied with musical talent this year, and look forward to some pleasurable seasons of enjoyment of this gift of God.

THE Chorus Class of over one hundred is busy with the cantata, "Under the Palms," by George F. Root, and seems to be enjoying its work.

SOME figures from the quarterly report of the Missionary Volunteer Society may be of interest:—

Letters written	114
Letters received	46
Visits	278
Magazines loaned, etc.	578
Papers loaned, etc.	596
Tracts loaned, etc.	340
Books loaned, etc.	29
Hours Christian Help Work	161
Offerings	£13 5s. 9d.

THE Society's gift chart is striking. A life-size figure points an arresting finger with the question, "Have you given all you can?" In the left hand is a book inscribed "The Bread of Life," and from below reach up thirteen imploring hands, representing the seeking millions. The plan is to fill with a portion of the Bread one hand at least each Sabbath, by attaining to the aim set for the weekly offering.

THE frame work for the Domestic Science building is going up apace. The floor joists for the first floor are now being put down, and we hope to have the building completed by the first of July. At that time Miss Edna Walker, who has finished the Bachelor of Science Course at the Emmanuel Missionary College, will be here to take charge of our Domestic Science work. Not only has Miss Walker had experience in Domestic Science but she has also had a great deal of experience in Library Science and Young People's work. We are sure that she will make a very valuable addition to our Faculty, and be able to give our young ladies very necessary training.

WE are planning this year to paint most of our College buildings. This work was begun last year, and the main chapel building and a portion of the young ladies' home have been painted. We are finishing the latter and planning to do all the rest of the buildings this year. Brother M. Stelter is in charge of the work, being assisted by a number of the boys. The buildings certainly look fresher in their new coat of paint.

SOUTH NEW SOUTH WALES

PRESIDENT: J. M. COLE
SECRETARY: W. H. HOPKIN

Tumut

ON account of the scattered interest in this district, I have not been doing anything in the way of a public effort, but spend my time visiting and holding cottage meetings. As a result, under the Lord's blessing, souls are taking their stand for the message.

Altogether we have about twenty adults and about half that number of children who are coming along nicely in the message. While none of these have been admitted into church membership, many are awaiting the privilege of baptism. Besides the number already mentioned we have two families who have been long in the message and take an active part in our work here. One family of new Sabbath-keepers, a mother and five children, have moved to Albury. This number may seem large when on paper, but from our viewpoint their scattered condition makes the company appear small.

In Tumut only about sixteen are able to attend Sabbath school, but besides this we have two other small Sabbath schools, one at Tumut Plain, seven miles away, and the other at Adelong, twelve miles distant; and we have other families who spend the Sabbath alone.

Among our new Sabbath-keepers is the Government Forest Officer for this district, a man of good social standing, and we are glad to say that he with his family is taking a very live interest in the message.

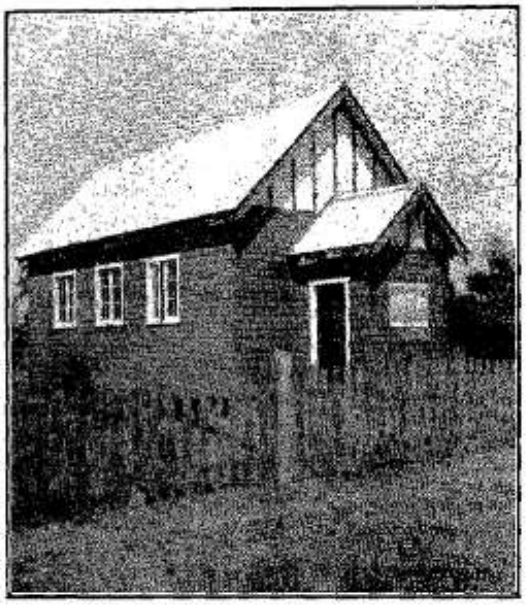
On my last visit with one of my readers, a dear old lady who has been a Roman Catholic, I was glad to learn that she and her daughter have commenced to treat Friday as the preparation day, and keep God's Sabbath. We hope to see them, with the three children, meeting with us in a little while. Truly God is good, and the gospel of Christ is still "the power of God unto salvation."

Our little company is an earnest band of workers, doing its best to carry the light of God to those around them. Each week we sell forty *Signs* and find that it not only brings a blessing to the buyer, but our dear people are gaining experiences that help to brighten up their path and give a taste of the joy that comes from association with the Master in soul-winning.

I expect to get a motor cycle as soon as possible, which will help me very much in getting around to the people who live miles out among the mountains. Since coming here to Tumut I have visited homes hidden away in the mountains that the canvasser has never visited.

I believe there is a big work to be done in this part of the field which will not be done in a month or two, but will result in many souls for the kingdom.

T. R. KENT.



Bowral Church, N.S.W.

Built during mission conducted by Pastor D. G. Meyers and Brother Parsons, and dedicated June 3, 1923

Progress at Arncliffe

SABBATH, March 29, will be long remembered by members of the Arncliffe church as a very happy day in the Lord's service. There was a splendid attendance at the morning service, when a goodly number joined in celebrating the Lord's Supper. The gracious Spirit of the Lord was very manifest upon hearts, and it was indeed good to be present.

Arncliffe has very considerably added to its membership the last two years, and although some have moved away to other churches, the present membership is quite up to expectations. A most pleasing feature in the history of the church is that all are faithful tithe-payers. In the afternoon a baptismal service was held, and four new members were added to the church. There will be further additions in a few weeks' time, as others have already decided to follow their Lord in this ordinance.

It is just two years ago that we as workers settled in this district to endeavour to build up the work, and it is very gratifying to us and to the local church officers to see the advancement in growth of membership, and the strong financial assistance rendered to the cause of truth in tithes and offerings.

The writer had the privilege of spending Sabbath, March 29, with this church and felt it was one of those "best days" in our Christian ministry.

H. MITCHELL.

"KINDNESS creates an atmosphere in which the most sensitive and diffident natures develop and reveal themselves."

WEST AUSTRALIA

PRESIDENT: H. E. PIPER
SECRETARY: P. P. GOODING

West Australian Conference

MARCH 4 to 16 was the time set for our camp-meeting this year, but several days before the appointed day a number were preparing their tents for habitation. Kitchener Park, Subiaco, was the place of encampment, the use of this park having been granted by the council of the Subiaco municipality.

The camp this year was the largest ever held in this conference, and without doubt the best. Reports revealed the fact that the conference was made up of nineteen churches with a membership of 756. Forty-four souls had received baptism during the year. The newly organised church at Albany was received into the sisterhood of churches, making the number up to twenty. An examination of the finances of the conference showed the present worth to be £1,916 14s. 2d., this being an increase of £322 10s. 6d. for the year. The tithe receipts for the year amounted to £4,698 4s. 4d., which is an increase of approximately £400 above the previous year.

The Sabbath School Department report was encouraging. The offerings reached the highest mark yet recorded in this conference, the total being £893. The Sabbath school offerings for the two Sabbaths of camp were also record offerings for this conference. The total amounted to £55 which is £14 higher than last year.

The Holy Spirit's presence was manifest on the Sabbath days, and many souls turned to the Lord. At the foreign mission service on the afternoon of the last Sabbath, £743 was given in cash and pledges for missions.

The usual standing committees were appointed by the delegates, and their reports, which were adopted, are as follows:—

MINISTERIAL CREDENTIALS: H. E. Piper, A. H. Britten, G. Robinson.

MINISTERIAL LICENSE: H. J. Meyers, W. N. Lock, C. V. Bell, M. B. C. Smith, R. Brandstater, R. H. Constandt, R. R. Gooding.

MISSIONARY LICENSE: E. A. Turner, A. Markey, Miss F. Reed, Nurse E. Heise, and Mrs. S. G. Tank.

TEACHER'S LICENSE: Misses E. Clarke, R. Clarke, A. Clarke, G. Clark, N. Sheed, and Mrs. M. E. Davey.

COLPORTEUR'S LICENSE: A. P. House, C. J. Veitch, C. Beattie, A. V. Stenhouse, Miss I. Hardie, and Miss E. M. Forbes.

All other names to be referred to the executive committee.

Nominations

PRESIDENT: H. E. Piper.

SECRETARY-TREASURER: R. R. Gooding.

FIELD MISSIONARY SECRETARY: E. A. Turner.

HOME MISSIONARY SECRETARY: H. J. Meyers.

SABBATH SCHOOL SECRETARY: Mrs. S. G. Tank.

MISSIONARY VOLUNTEER SECRETARY: H. J. Meyers.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE: H. E. Piper, E. Rosendahl, W. A. Wilton, W. G. Spencer, R. H. Constandt, J. Lang, S. Davies.

DARLING RANGE SCHOOL BOARD: H. E. Piper, E. Rosendahl, G. H. Palmateer, W. A. Wilton, G. Chapman.

Plans and Recommendations

Our people entered enthusiastically into the discussion and adoption of the plans suggested for the extension and upbuilding of God's work, among which may be mentioned the following: Personal soul-winning endeavour with the aid of our greatly improved *Signs of the Times* and the special edition of "Steps to Christ;" the Big Week effort, in which we hope to raise £175 to help the General Conference in carrying out its world-wide programme; the Appeal for Missions; the suggested aim of 2s. 10d. per week per member to missions; the One Per Cent plan, and the Students' Aid Fund; the Reading and Standard of Attainment Courses; and the European Relief Fund. Our confidence in the writings of the Spirit of Prophecy was reaffirmed and the need urged to study these as never before.

The baptismal service held on the last day of the camp was a very solemn occasion. Twenty-five were baptised.

In closing this report we would thank God for His goodness to His people and His guiding hand in the work of this conference.

H. E. PIPER, *President.*
R. R. GOODING, *Secretary.*

SOUTH NEW ZEALAND

PRESIDENT: W. J. WESTERMAN
SECRETARY: A. G. MINCHIN

A Prompt Answer

THE following is an experience related by one of our canvassers who is endeavouring to earn sufficient money to pay his way through our missionary school: "I had a wonderful experience last week. I canvassed hard for a book and could not get an order. At last I said that I would have to leave, and when I got out of sight of the house I kneeled down and prayed for the Lord to show me my mistake, for I could not see it myself. Well, before I got up from my knees, I heard the little girl running down the path and she told me to put her mother down for a £1 binding. This reminded me of that text in Isaiah 65:24, 'And it shall come to pass, that before they call, I will answer; and while they are yet speaking I will hear.'"

In a later letter the same canvasser tells the following experience: "On Monday I worked a river bed called the Puhipuhi and didn't get an order. Then on Monday night I stayed at nearly the last house, but there was one about ten miles up. The people tried to discourage me from going, but that didn't stop me. It took me nearly four hours to reach the place, but I sold a book and walked two more miles to an out-station and sold another book. Then two days after I went up another valley, only it was twice as bad because the mud in places was over my boot-tops; but at the end of this valley I also sold two more books—both to Roman Cath lics. So this shows that if we let Satan discourage us we are missing orders, and what is more, we are missing souls that are precious. I have just been studying the 2,300 days' prophecy in "Bible Readings." Since I have been studying the book itself, I am getting more to like it. I find the more I study the Bible, the harder I am to discourage. I think the devil thinks so, too. I suppose you remember the study that we had at school that Brother Scragg took when he said to try to discourage the devil with a text. Well, I often think of that when he is trying to discourage me. I then comfort myself with the fact that it is not my work but the Lord's work, and He will give us strength to stand. Deut. 31:23."

A. G. MINCHIN.

Interesting Facts Did the Work

A GENTLEMAN on learning my mission immediately produced some silver, probably five shillings, before I had time to explain anything about our work. Ignoring the money I continued to give a few interesting facts. Gradually the hand holding the money slipped into a pocket and one guinea was entered on my card.

A solicitor greeted me with, "Hello, Miss Jones, come for another half guinea, have you?" He immediately went for his cash-box, which for once was not a welcome sight. Interesting facts again did their work. He, too, wrote one guinea.

After canvassing one man and receiving his donation I asked him if there was any one else who was likely to be interested in missions. "No, I don't think so, but you may try Mr. B—— if you like." You will be pleased to learn that Mr. B—— could be made sufficiently interested to make a donation and to introduce me to four others who also gave. One old man, usually known as "Scottie," surprised us by giving one guinea. Their gifts to missions totalled three pounds.

I had just completed my canvass of a merchant, and he had agreed that the work was a worthy one, when another man entered the office. The merchant, rising from his chair said, addressing me, "You want all you can get in the way of donations, don't you? I'll canvass this man. He's worth a guinea, I guess."

He did—two guineas are better than one. After canvassing in the same manner as I had done, he said, "You see I listened."

A Chinese who gave me one pound last year said, "Missions do good in my country, me give two pounds."

The Lord dealt liberally with me, giving me £53 10s. for three and a half days' work.

ALICE V. JONES.

I KNOW of but one elevation of a human being, and that is elevation of soul. Without this it matters nothing where a man stands or what he possesses; with it he towers, he is one of God's nobility, no matter what place he holds in the social scale.—*Channing.*

OBITUARIES

NEELY.—Kathleen May Neely fell asleep in Jesus at a private hospital in Rochester, Victoria, on March 13, 1924, aged nineteen years. Kathleen was a bright girl, and was beloved by all who knew her. She with her mother and four sisters accepted the present-day message under the labours of Brother Ross James five years ago at Rochester. She remained faithful until death. At our annual camp-meeting held at Alphington last January, she re-consecrated her life to the Master. Sixteen days prior to her death she was stricken with double pneumonia. Through it all she was patient and displayed Christian fortitude. Both doctors and nurses said they never ministered to a better type of Christian girl. We laid her to rest in the Rochester cemetery March 14. A large number of friends and relatives attended the funeral. A number of Bendigo church members travelled by train thirty-eight miles to pay their last tribute of respect by joining in the funeral procession. We are convinced that, when the Archangel's trump shall sound Kathleen will come forth clad in glorious immortality. Services in the home and at the graveside were conducted by the writer.

THOS. H. CRADDOCK.

GADSDEN.—John Gadsden died March 24, 1924, at his home, Keysborough, Dandenong, Victoria, twelve days after a severe stroke. His wife, Sister H. E. Gadsden, accepted the message over twenty years ago as the result of reading a book sold by a canvasser. Five sons and six daughters are also left to mourn their loss, among whom are Sister H. C. Harker, Sister W. O. Johanson, Sister C. C. Forsyth, Sister Horace Steed, Sister Mason of one of our Melbourne churches, and the youngest, Vera, who is at home with her mother. Our sincerest sympathies go out to this family who mourn the loss of a faithful husband and kind father. Mr. Gadsden, while not having embraced the message, often took the opportunity of telling others about the change of the Sabbath as being the work of the apostate church, and had pleasure in scattering tracts concerning the second advent among his acquaintances. A week prior to her husband's fatal stroke, Sister Gadsden came out of the hospital after a severe operation. The Lord seemed to strengthen her in a wonderful way to minister to her loved one during his last hours. Our prayer is that the arms of omnipotent love will be about dear Sister Gadsden in this, the most trying experience of her life. In the presence of a large gathering of friends and family relatives, on a very wet day, we laid this pilgrim to rest in the Dandenong cemetery, at the age of sixty-five years. Services in the home and at the graveside were conducted by the writer.

THOS. H. CRADDOCK.

BEGIN by denying yourself, and by and by you forget yourself. The kindness which was at first just a duty becomes a pleasure and a joy. Self-denial becomes glorified into self-forgetfulness.—*Brooke Herford.*

Our Seventh Appeal for Missions Campaign

Reports from Conferences to April 5

Conference	Weeks	Amount	Per cent of Goal
South New Zealand	5	£911	107
North N. S. W.	3	1,050	95
North New Zealand	6	2,097	64
Victoria-Tasmania	3	2,091	64
South N. S. W.	3	1,293	47
West Australia	1	362	36
Union Conference		£7,804	52

WE are glad to be able to pass on the word at this time that more than half of the Union Conference aim of £15,000 has been reached.

AT the time of going to press, no report has come to hand from North New Zealand for the seventh week of their effort.

WE welcome the first report from West Australia, £362 for the first week. This is excellent, being £262 above that collected in the same time last year, and more than one-third of the total aimed for.

THE North N.S.W. Conference lacked only £50 of reaching its aim in three weeks' effort. They may still have the honour of finishing the work in the shortest time. We expect word any hour telling of victory in the North.

ONE sister, who cannot possibly engage in active work because she is an invalid, writes stating that she has set apart a definite time each day for prayer for the success of the campaign. Will not others do likewise?

"NEVER go out appealing without prayer. Keep praying while appealing. If discouraged, pray. Mingle praise and thanksgiving with all your prayers. The wealth of the world is God's. God's work needs money now. Ask and it shall be given you. Keep asking."

OUR congratulations to South New Zealand, the first to reach the aim set for it by the Union Conference! This conference has set its own goal at £1,100 as the one suggested by the Union was not big enough. We appreciate this spirit of helpfulness and wish them all success as they press on.

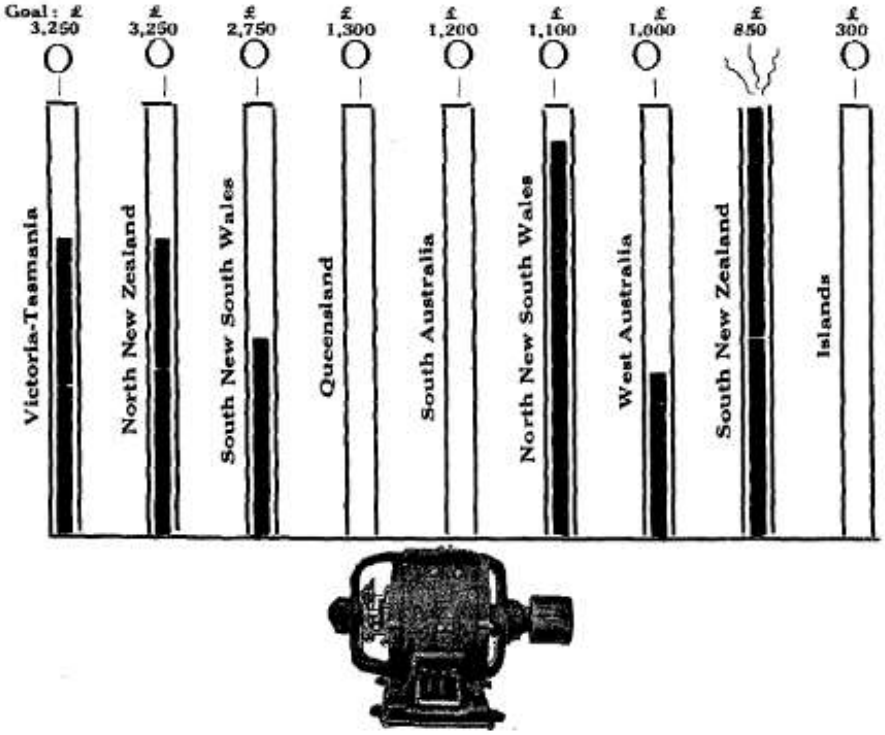
WE rejoice to know that four churches in the South N.S.W. Conference—Wollongong, Ashfield, Harden, and Temora—have reached their aims and are now assisting other companies. "They helped every one his neighbour; and every one said to his brother, Be of good courage." Isa. 41 : 6.

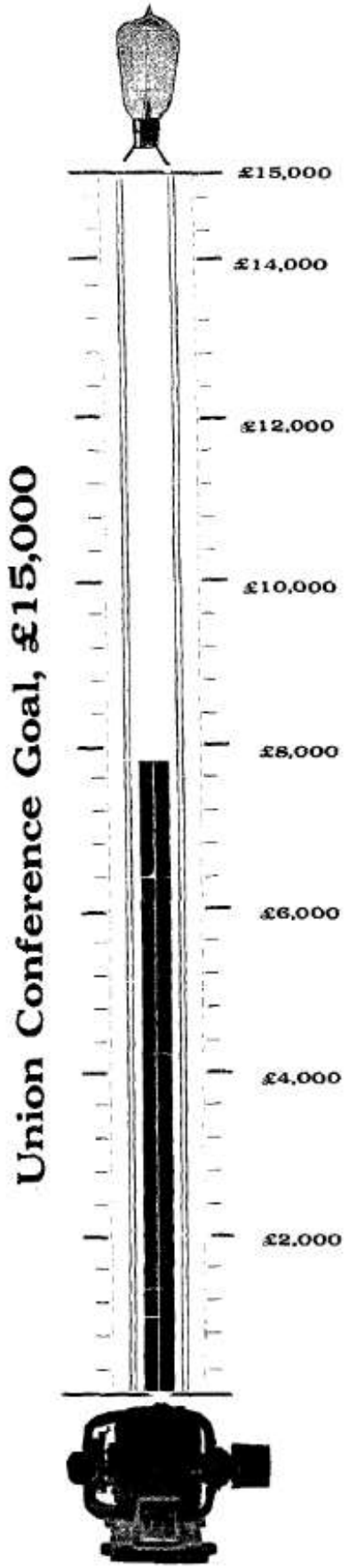
OUR readers who are anxiously watching this page from week to week will be delighted with the splendid progress the Appeal is making. One conference already "over the top," another nearly there in only three weeks' time, and two more over half-way to their goals, are some of the interesting features revealed in this week's report.

THE Lord is using sympathetic friends not of our faith to gather in the means, as the following will show: The husband of a church member took his wife's collecting card to the bowling green, and in the happy and friendly manner which characterises him, asked his fellow bowlers for donations in such a way as to leave no openings for refusals. The result was 13/- for missions

KEEP ON KEEPING ON

"TOO many of us measure our effort by what the world says of it."





Australasian Record

THE OFFICIAL ORGAN OF THE
AUSTRALASIAN UNION CONFERENCE OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS

Single Subscriptions per year, post paid - - 5/-

Editors
J. E. Fulton, W. G. Turner, F. A. Allum, Anna L. Hindson (Office Editor)

All copy for the paper should be sent to Mrs. Hindson, "Mizpah," Wahroonga, N.S.W.

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ONE brother in the Iowa Conference, U. S. A., set his personal goal to collect $3,000 (£600) in thirty days in their latest Ingathering campaign, and under the special blessing of God he was able to bring in $3,040 (£608) in twenty-eight days.

SISTER W. J. Smith, wife of Pastor Smith, our Sanitarium Chaplain, fell asleep in Jesus on Sunday, April 6, at the Sydney Sanitarium, after a long illness. Our sympathies are with Brother Smith and the members of his family. The obituary notice will appear in our next issue.

THE most successful of any Harvest Ingathering campaign in the history of the work from a financial standpoint, was the effort of last October and November in North America, when £116,272 was turned into the treasury. This was over £8,200 more than the sum raised the previous year.

A MESSAGE from New Guinea: "The people of the mountains are very anxious to have their missionary," Brother Peacock writes to the Union office. "Only the other day one of their leading men asked me when their missionary was coming, and I told him very soon now. He said, 'How glad I will be when we have missionaries of our own.'"

A SOLICITOR in Auckland expressed his pleasure at the beautiful magazine we were circulating in connection with the Appeal, and said he was glad to give a guinea toward it. While the cheque was being brought in, our worker talked with him a little and mentioned our beliefs regarding the Papacy. The lawyer did not say very much, but when the cheque arrived he altered the figures, adding another half-guinea, because our opinions were so much like his own.

THE greater part of London has been divided into districts for the more efficient carrying forward of the evangelistic work in that city. In the western district at Wimbledon, under the superintendency of Pastor W. Maudsley, an effort is being conducted. Over 1,300 people were present at the first meeting. In the northern district Pastor L. W. Barras commenced a series of meetings with no fewer than 2,500 in attendance. Our English church paper in speaking of this effort says that it was undoubtedly the largest meeting ever conducted by Seventh-day Adventists in the British Isles. By the splendid interest manifested there should be good results from these efforts.

IN appreciation of the gift of clothing sent to Monamona Mission by our people, particularly by the Brisbane church, Brother Branford writes: "We wish to express our heartfelt thanks to our people for their sacrifice in supplying us with these good clothes. You need not worry thinking they might be too heavy for the people on the mission. The winter will soon be here. We have very mild winters, but our people feel the cold and they will find the warm clothing just the thing to keep Jack Frost out."

"WE are enjoying the best of health," writes Brother C. S. Palmer from the Buresala Training School, Fiji, "although summer's heat is trying to do its worst just now. We have a fine body of students, consecrated to the message. Some of them are looking forward to the June meeting for appointment to the work. The RECORD is a most welcome visitor, as it keeps us in touch with the workers in the home fields as well as with those in mission work. The notes from the various local conferences, giving the location of various workers, and their public efforts, is a splendid idea."

AN accident on April 6 resulted in a serious injury to Brother W. R. Carswell. While he was helping our blind sister, Miss Emily Gordon, across George Street, Sydney, a passing motor bus skidded on the wet road and crashed into both of them. They were conveyed by ambulance to the Sydney Hospital. Sister Gordon's injuries are not serious, but an X-ray examination reveals that Brother Carswell has a fractured thigh. We regret that this faithful worker has been laid aside for a time, but hope that he will again be restored to health and to the work to which he has been so devoted. Even now while lying ill in hospital, his thoughts are upon the work from which he has been so suddenly removed.

IN a letter just received from Pastor Parker he passes on the latest word from the various mission stations in the New Hebrides: "Encouraging reports are still coming from Ambrim, and more are accepting the message there. Brother and Sister Nicholson are in the best of spirits and of good courage. Brother and Sister James write very hopefully of their work at Big Bay, and say that their Sabbath services are now largely attended, and a new interest has developed at the back of their mission station. What they have in hand is being faithfully shepherded, and they are arranging for the new interests to be safeguarded. The Lord is giving us the victory here on Atchin, but we have further battles ahead of us before the complete victory is gained. It is a battle and a march; a battle and a march; but the outcome is assured."

PASTOR F. A. Allum writes: "When I was visiting one of the churches, some one remarked that Harvest Ingathering work was begging. Brother Sandeman's approach is the reverse of that. He went up to one of the wealthiest homes in Melbourne recently. He was tired and weary, having collected only a few shillings that morning, but his heart was full of courage still. As he walked up to the door he met two of the most fashionable ladies of Melbourne with this salutation, "Good morning, I have come on the King's business." One lady asked, "And what might the King's business be?" He then explained the nature of his business. She was interested, and brought him out a cheque for £2 2s. 0d. We can either look up and see the stars or look down and see the mud in this campaign. We can either call it begging, or the King's business as did Brother Sandeman."

European Relief Fund

Previously Acknowl'd	£353	14	5
Ayr, Queensland	1	10	0
Mrs. M. A. E. Snell		10	0
Haden Church	5	0	0
Mr. & Mrs. L. A. Borgas	3	0	0
Mrs. C. Palmer	1	0	0
H. B. P. Wicks	3	0	0
Osborne Park Ch., W.A.	1	5	0
A. Von der Heyde	5	0	0
J. Clarke, Sen.	1	2	6
Mrs. Simpson		5	0
Miss S. Barrett	2	0	0
T. Jarrad	1	0	0
Miss H. Horner		10	0
T. Thatcher	5	0	0
Mr. & Mrs. Thomas	2	0	0
	£385	16	11

Standing of Subscription List "Signs of the Times"

April 1, 1924

State	Clubs	Singles	Total	Av. per member
South New Zealand	507	139	646	2.43
West Australia	1373	457	1830	2.4
South N. S. Wales	2732	463	3195	2.24
Victoria-Tasmania	2625	1204	3829	2.12
South Australia	747	510	1257	2.03
North New Zealand	1643	247	1890	1.89
Queensland	812	368	1180	1.69
North N. S. Wales	800	290	1090	1.09
	11239	3678	14917	

Total average in all States 1.97 per member

Total Circulation for March

Victoria-Tasmania	...	19,264
South New South Wales	...	15,923
North New Zealand	...	9,416
West Australia	...	9,024
Queensland	...	8,235
South Australia	..	6,196
North New South Wales	...	5,137
South New Zealand	...	3,178
		76,373

Dates to Remember

Camp-Meetings :—

Queensland: May 6-18.
South N.S.W.: October 9-19

Week of Prayer: June 7-14
Union Conference Council: Aug. 20-

Sabbath School Members, Attention!

PLEASE make this alteration on the front cover of your new lesson pamphlets. Under "Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, June 24, 1924," cross out the words, "Japan and Korea," and write in, "Our Training Schools for Native Workers in Fiji and the Solomons."